

The 6:15

SATURDAY · SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

NO. 14

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (NEXT 10 DAYS) · WEEKEND EDITION, CONDENSED

Mon 9/14	GCC and Iranian diplomats reportedly to meet on a temporary Hormuz shipping arrangement [NEW, single-sourced] . Tue 9/15: Delaware's statewide primary — last of the 2026 cycle, four-way Dem Senate primary incl. Coons; early voting through 9/13.
Tue-Wed 9/15-16	FOMC decision/SEP Wed 2p, presser 2:30p — hike odds (a hike, not a cut) roughly 86-91% on CME FedWatch as of Fri post-CPI [see Lead] . Wed 9/16 aft. close: Lennar earnings, cons. ~\$1.30 GAAP EPS, rev. ~\$8.37B (-5% y/y). Fri 9/18 aft. close: FedEx, cons. EPS \$4.28-4.38, rev. ~\$23.1B.
[scheduled, uncertain]	SpaceX Starship Flight 14 — still split NET 9/15 vs. NET 9/18, FAA approval pending, not reconciled this run.
[NEW, retrospective]	Positron AI raised \$875M at a \$5B valuation (9/10); Sakana AI shipped Fugu Ultra v2.0 and Fugu Max, DeepSeek released V4.1 Flash (1M-token context) — both 9/10-11.

METRICS · AS OF FRI 9/11 CLOSE UNLESS NOTED

Oil/rates/vol	Brent settled \$104.61 (-2.8% Fri, +8.7% wk) on reports of Monday's Gulf talks [see Lead] ; WTI \$100.05 (-2.4% Fri, +9.4% wk). 10Y 4.96% (touched 4.979% intraday, no 5% cross); 2Y 4.63% [single-sourced] ; 30Y not confirmed as of press time. VIX 15.84 (-11.21%).
Equities/FX/other	Dow 52,573.29 (+0.98%), S&P 500 7,656.98 (+0.86%), Nasdaq Comp. 26,333.04 (+0.96%) — snapped Thu's 4-session losing streak. DXY ~99.11 (+0.06%); gold ~\$4,385/oz, roughly flat; retail gas \$4.3104/gal natl. avg (AAA, Sat 9/12), +2¢ on the day; Nikkei 63,844 (-2.19%, Fri Tokyo close).

Crude: ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month settle. Rates: Fed H.15/CME. Equities: exchange closes/CNBC/AP. No fresher Europe close than Thu 9/10 located this run **[stale]**.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 195 (straits.live, 9/12 1013Z) vs. Day 196 (globalsecurity.org, 9/11) — trackers remain a day apart, unreconciled.
Transits	Kpler 10-day avg. rose to 15/day (from ~13 last issue), but Thu's single-day count was 7 (11 the day prior) — both far below the ~85/day pre-crisis baseline. Lloyd's List: no fresher figure than the 8/26-9/1 ~12/day already reported.
Dark tankers/AIS	straits.live's "stranded vessel" counter — a different metric than last issue's 24h dark-tanker read — shows +171 in 24h to 490 total (7-day range 219-512) [metric change, not a verified real-world spike] .
War-risk premia	Unchanged ~\$10.0M/VLCC (~40x peacetime, straits.live), now "set 25 days ago" — aging, not a fresh quote.
Strikes (24-48h)	Houthis seized Mokha port (9/10) and Perim/Mayyun Island (9/11) — Bab el-Mandeb, not Hormuz; see Iran & Hormuz. Saudi Arabia shut a bypass pipeline 9/12. One unconfirmed, single-sourced claim (search snippet only) of an IRGC strike on a US Saildrone and a UKMTO report of projectiles hitting two vessels near Khasab, Oman [not independently verified] .

Kpler's AIS averages, Lloyd's List's weekly aggregation, and straits.live's day-specific/stranded-vessel snapshots measure different populations over different windows — never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Mets 6-4 Fri 9/11 (Bellinger 3-run HR, Rice HR) — 85-62; lead AL wild card by 5.5 over Boston, trail Tampa Bay by 3.0 in the AL East.
Knicks	Hart extension (3-yr/\$60-62M eyed) still unsigned — unchanged.
Northwestern	Bye week; hosts Colorado Sat. 9/19, 6:30p CT.

LEAD

A hot core CPI print pushes Fed hike odds above 85%, but stocks rally through it and oil — this week's other inflation driver — reverses hard on a Gulf diplomacy report

Friday delivered two readings that should have pointed the same direction and didn't. August CPI matched consensus on the headline — +0.4% m/m, +3.4% y/y, unchanged from July — but core came in at +0.3% m/m against a 0.2% consensus, the largest core advance since April, while core held at +2.4% y/y. [fact] BLS attributed more than a third of the headline gain to a 3.9% m/m jump in gasoline prices, meaning the "hot" surprise was concentrated in the core reading — shelter, services, or goods pass-through — not simply energy passing through twice. [fact]

The market's first move was mechanical: CME FedWatch's odds of a hike at the Sept. 15-16 FOMC — a hike, the unusual direction this cycle has been pricing since Thursday's oil/PPI shock — jumped further, to somewhere in the 86-91% range depending on the snapshot, up from Friday morning's already-elevated 69-70%. [fact] The 10-year yield touched 4.979% intraday before closing at 4.96%, just short of the 5% level that's held since November 2023; the 2-year's move was reported larger, to 4.63% by one source, though that figure comes from a single yield-snapshot service and isn't independently corroborated here. [flag: single-sourced] A short end moving harder than the long end is the same bear-flattening signature this issue has seen before an inflation-driven hike repricing: it says the market is pricing a near-term policy response to

a supply shock, not a reassessment of where inflation or growth sit over the next decade. [read]

What didn't follow the script was equities. All three major averages snapped Thursday's four-session losing streak: the Dow rose 0.98% to 52,573.29, the S&P 500 gained 0.86% to 7,656.98, and the Nasdaq added 0.96% to 26,333.04. The VIX fell 11.21% to 15.84, its sharpest one-day drop of the week. [fact] That's not the reaction textbook logic would predict for a session that also saw the market price in higher hike odds — unless the second half of Friday's data explains it: oil, the week's other inflation driver, reversed hard. Brent settled at \$104.61, down 2.8% on the day (still up 8.7% on the week), and WTI fell 2.4% to \$100.05 (+9.4% on the week), with the pullback tied to reports that GCC and Iranian diplomats are set to meet Monday on a temporary Hormuz shipping arrangement. [fact, single-sourced this run via CNBC]

Put together, Friday's tape reads as a market treating the CPI print and the oil reversal as separate signals rather than reconciling them into one view: hike odds went up because the data said so, but risk appetite came back because the marginal driver of this week's inflation scare — oil, not core services — looked like it might already be turning, days before the Fed even meets. [read] That creates a real setup risk into Wednesday: if the Fed hikes on Thursday's spike and Friday's CPI, and the Gulf talks produce even a partial de-escalation before the decision, policymakers could find themselves tightening into a shock the market has already started pricing out — a "one meeting behind" problem rather than a policy mistake, but one this issue will be watching for in Wednesday's statement language. [read] Nothing about Monday's reported meeting has been confirmed as an actual, scheduled, on-the-record

event by any of the parties involved; treat it as a reported signal that already moved the oil market, not a fact about what will happen Monday. [flag]

BUSINESS

Friday's full session undercut both of Thursday's post-earnings premarket reads. Oracle, which had traded as much as 6-7% higher premarket (touching roughly \$163) on its AI-cloud backlog beat, gave the entire move back and closed at \$150.28, down 1.74% on the day — the "cloud demand outpacing supply" headline that drove the premarket pop didn't survive full-session trading. [NEW, corrects Friday's premarket figure] Adobe did the opposite: after an intraday slide of 3-4% to roughly \$248 that echoed Thursday's premarket sell-off, it recovered to close at \$252.23, up 1.37%. [NEW, corrects Friday's premarket figure] The reversal in both names argues against reading either stock's premarket reaction as the market's real verdict on an earnings beat — full-day trading, not the first hour, is where Friday actually landed.

TECHNOLOGY

OpenAI's side of the Navier-Stokes dispute hardened. OpenAI researcher Sebastien Bubeck publicly rejected NYU mathematician Tristan Buckmaster's allegation that OpenAI pressured him to drop an Anthropic-affiliated co-author's name from the announcement, calling the claim "false and inflammatory," while maintaining OpenAI's roughly 10,000-agent model solved the problem independently over 88 hours. [DEVELOPING] Buckmaster's side has not withdrawn its allegation; the dispute remains contested and

unresolved between the two accounts, with no independent verification of either version located this run.

GEOPOLITICS

ISW's Friday assessment logged 162 Russian drones launched overnight into Sept. 11 across multiple regions, with no territorial change reported on either side; Ukraine continued long-range strikes on logistics targets, building on Wednesday's roughly 3,000km strike on Makhachkala's Caspian port, which isn't repeated in detail here. [continuity] Separately, Ukraine and Canada signed a 100-year partnership agreement on Sept. 10 that includes a drone-production component, per Zelensky and Prime Minister Carney. [NEW] Reports that Putin, at a BRICS summit, said European troops in Ukraine "would mean war with Russia," and that Indonesia confirmed continued Russian petroleum purchases despite sanctions, both reached this issue only via single aggregator sources and were not cross-verified against a primary readout; treat both as directional, not confirmed. [flag] No new Witkoff-Kushner shuttle development was located since their Sept. 5-6 trip. [continuity]

IRAN & HORMUZ

The market angle on this week's Gulf story is in the Lead; the ground-level picture moved separately and further. Houthi forces seized the port of Mokha on Sept. 10 and Perim (Mayyun) Island on Sept. 11 — confirmed independently by NPR, CNBC and the Washington Times — putting Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline to roughly 75km north of Bab el-Mandeb under Houthi control, per a [globalsecurity.org](https://www.globalsecurity.org) aggregator readout of the wider conflict. [NEW] Saudi Arabia responded with airstrikes on Mokha's rebel-held airport on Sept. 11. [fact] These are Bab el-Mandeb/Red Sea developments, a distinct chokepoint from the Strait of Hormuz itself, though a

Houthi-controlled Red Sea coastline widens the set of maritime pressure points a Gulf settlement would eventually need to address. [read] On the Mecca Joint Defence Agreement flagged last issue, the only new item located is a Jerusalem Post report that Iran has been "invited" to join the Pakistan-Saudi-Turkey pact, sourced to a single unnamed Iranian official and not confirmed by any government; no direct response from Saudi Arabia, Turkey, or Iran to Pakistan's Sept. 9 activation comment was found this run. [flag: unconfirmed]

SPORTS

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Weekend edition. Calendar/Metrics condensed; Politics and Economics cut — nothing broke beyond what's carried in the Lead; Sports to two lines/team.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since Friday: Nvidia-Hugging Face deal terms (\$12.93B, confirmed 9/3); Amazon FTC ad-auction suit; Ford/CATL battery scrutiny; Anthropic IPO timeline; Starship Flight 14's date split; Knicks' Hart extension. Watch: whether Monday's reported GCC-Iran shipping talks occur and what they produce before Wednesday's FOMC; the FOMC decision itself; corroboration of the 2-year and 30-year Friday closes, neither independently confirmed this run; any government response to Iran's reported Mecca-pact invitation; independent verification of the Navier-Stokes dispute.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.